ISSUE #3 · WEEK 45 · 1–8 NOV 2026

# The Weekly Signal

Geopolitics, Switzerland, money, Bitcoin and AI, read from Mattia's newsletters, feeds and podcasts and checked against the open web. The week in five minutes is the core read; the full issue is about 30 minutes.

FACT reported by two outlets or primary data · OPINION a source's argument · CLAUDE Claude's own reading · SOURCE where it comes from · UNCONFIRMED single or anonymous source

IN THIS ISSUE

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## The week in five minutes

1. **Democrats took both houses of Congress.** The midterm rout included Senate seats in Texas and Kansas and the defeat of Susan Collins; Trump conceded that the Iran war cost his party the vote but said he would fight it again.

   Why it matters: Trump keeps foreign policy and his veto, but loses the Senate that confirms his nominees and funds his war.

2. **The AI trade had its worst day since 2020.** On Thursday the Nasdaq fell about 5.5% (the Nasdaq 100 6.4%) on fears that the Democratic sweep and local votes against data centers will slow the build-out; Taiwan and Korea followed on Friday.

   Why it matters: the bet is no longer only on chips and demand, but on power, permits and voters.

3. **Oil fell 17% in a week while ships kept sinking.** Brent dropped from about $118 to $98 on a supply glut and talk of diplomacy, yet 11 ships were attacked around Hormuz and three sank.

   Why it matters: a price that assumes peace meets a strait that runs at a third of normal.

4. **Gold rose 4.5% and yields fell.** Gold ended at about $4,075 and the US 10-year at 4.86%, as investors switched from fearing inflation to fearing slower growth.

   Why it matters: markets still expect a Fed hike in December, so that switch is fragile.

5. **Bitcoin slipped 3% and ETFs lost $1.3 billion.** It traded between about $74,800 and $81,100 and ended the week near $75,900 (CHF 62,200).

   Why it matters: Bitcoin is trading with tech stocks for now, not as a hedge against them.

6. **Swiss inflation hit 1.5%, the highest since 2023.** Petroleum products cost 40% more than a year ago, while core inflation stayed at 0.5%; petrol fell back below CHF 2 a litre by Friday.

# 1 Geopolitics

## Iran: the vote is over, the war is not

WIDELY COVERED

FACT The week began with diplomacy. Iranian negotiators spent a third day in Doha with Qatari mediators, Secretary of State Marco Rubio said President Trump prefers a diplomatic end, and Brent fell about 6% on Monday. The military track never stopped: the US quietly struck Iran's Qeshm Island in the Strait of Hormuz on the eve of the vote, and two projectiles hit the island again on Friday night. Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei put the armed forces on alert, and security chief Mohsen Rezaei said Tehran is debating whether to drop its ban on nuclear weapons if fighting resumes. The UK's maritime agency UKMTO counted at least 11 ships attacked in and around the strait in the week to 6 November, three of them sunk, with traffic about 65% below pre-war levels. Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi set out seven conditions for reopening the strait after calls with 12 counterparts. After the vote, Trump said the war was the defining issue behind the Republican defeat, yet that he would make the same choice again; Republican lawmakers are now pressing him to fire Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth and wind the war down. OPINION Rapidan Energy puts the chance that full fighting resumes at 80%, and Trita Parsi of the Quincy Institute says the short-term risk of war has risen since the midterms. John Mearsheimer argues that a cornered president has few good exits. CLAUDE Both readings can be true: Washington wants out, but a president who has just lost Congress needs a result he can call a win, and Tehran has just watched its energy squeeze help topple his majority. That argues for Iran holding out rather than settling. The number to watch is Hormuz transits, not statements: a strait at a third of normal traffic is a blockade in all but name.

SOURCE Al Jazeera: Qeshm island and Hormuz hit · Semafor Flagship: US quietly strikes Iranian island · Arab News: New US strikes hit Qeshm · Semafor Flagship: Midterms blamed on Iran war · Semafor Flagship: Calls for White House shakeup · Semafor Flagship: Oil up on Mideast fears · Reuters via SRN: Iranian negotiators in Doha · John Mearsheimer: The Election Is Over, but Iran Is Not

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## A weaker Trump at home, a freer one abroad

WIDELY COVERED

FACT Democrats won majorities in both the House and the Senate on 3 November. They took Senate seats in Texas and Kansas, a Republican seat since 1932, ousted Maine's Susan Collins, and won governorships in Texas, Georgia and Iowa; International Intrigue puts the House majority on track for up to 255 seats and the Senate at about 55. Vice President JD Vance wrote that the party lost because of the war, with petrol above $4 and diesel above $6. The presumptive Democratic speaker said the new majority will aim to end the war, scrap tariffs and restore health spending, and Democrats are preparing subpoenas for companies close to Trump. On election day Trump also said he had agreed with Netanyahu to wind down the $4 billion a year in US military aid to Israel two years early, by the end of this year. OPINION The longtime head of the Munich Security Conference told Politico that Europe should brace for "more acrimony"; a senior European lawmaker warned that a lame-duck Trump "could become an angry duck". CLAUDE Congress cannot order peace, but from January it controls the money and the confirmations, which turns the next two years into a fight over budgets, executive orders and courts. Abroad, where Congress has little grip, Trump has more reason to look for quick wins: Iran, Ukraine and trade with China are where to look first.

SOURCE Semafor Flagship: Democrats redraw US electoral map · International Intrigue: If you can't beat Dem · Semafor Flagship: Democrats' ambitious agenda · Semafor Flagship: Trump expected to go global · CNN: Trump on US aid to Israel · Semafor Flagship: CEOs, firms brace for subpoenas

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## Ukraine: strikes on Kyiv, talks in Abu Dhabi, and Europe says no to a grand bargain

FACT Washington said it will mediate direct talks between Russia and Ukraine in Abu Dhabi this coming week, with parallel talks with Europe on security guarantees. Before them, Russia escalated: a strike killed 29 people at an aid center early in the week, and on Friday night 36 ballistic missiles were fired at Kyiv and its region, President Zelensky said, of which four were shot down. The strikes hit the Pivnichnyi (Northern) Bridge over the Dnipro and disrupted heating and water. Russia said it downed almost 500 drones heading for Moscow. After meeting Putin's envoy Kirill Dmitriev, Trump spoke of a "very big" deal that "might involve all of Europe"; in Warsaw, EU foreign-policy chief Kaja Kallas rejected that, saying Europe already has a security architecture and Putin has no veto over it. OPINION Doomberg argues that Moscow timed cutting the Dnipro bridges to the wider war with Iran, while Washington's attention is in the Gulf. CLAUDE Hitting heat and bridges before talks is how Moscow bargains from strength. A deal on Europe's security made over Europe's head would not hold.

SOURCE Euronews: Russia fires North Korean missiles at Ukrainian energy facility · Euronews: EU rejects Trump's security deal · Semafor Flagship: US to mediate Russia-Ukraine talks · Doomberg: Attrition Pocket

# 2 World tour

## Europe

- FACT **Poland**'s Constitutional Tribunal split after seven judges suspended its president, accusing him of complicity in President Nawrocki's refusal to swear in judges chosen by parliament; Nawrocki called it a coup. On Saturday a gunman killed at least five people on Kraków's Main Square; no motive has been given. Euronews · Euronews
- FACT **France** held a general strike on Thursday over wages and public services; **Belgium**'s coalition broke over an $11 billion budget gap, with debt above 108% of GDP and borrowing costs at 15-year highs. Semafor · AP
- FACT **Hybrid pressure**: three days of hoax bomb threats diverted flights across Italy, Poland, Bulgaria and Spain, and on Thursday more than 21 flights were targeted; a French bank said hackers stole €100 million. Reuters · Semafor

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## Asia & China

- FACT **China** posted record exports and asked the US and EU to cut tariffs, offering more US farm purchases in return; it also added large tunnel-boring machines to its export controls. Semafor · Semafor
- FACT **Markets**: Taiwan had record losses and South Korea halted trading after an 8% fall on Friday, as the US tech sell-off spread. Semafor

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## Africa

- FACT **Nigeria**: a court voided the candidacy of former vice president Atiku Abubakar, the main challenger to President Tinubu, ten weeks before the vote; he will appeal. Semafor · Semafor Africa
- FACT **South Africa** voted in local elections with the ANC polling as low as 32%, days after the US said it will drop South Africa and Rwanda from duty-free AGOA access from 2027. Reuters · Semafor

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## Americas

- FACT **Paraguay**: Congress impeached President Santiago Peña after the collapse of Ueno Bank froze the savings of about half the country's adults; former vice president Pedro Alliana was sworn in on Friday and Peña is under house arrest. Euronews · UPI
- FACT **United States**: the economy added 165,000 jobs in October against a 12-month average of 48,000; unemployment held at 4.1%. BLS

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# 3 Switzerland

## Inflation at 1.5%: an oil shock, not yet a Swiss one

FACT Swiss consumer prices rose 1.5% in October from a year earlier, up from 1.0% in September and above all forecasts, the Federal Statistical Office said on Tuesday. It is the highest rate since December 2023. Petroleum products cost 40% more than a year ago, while core inflation, which excludes energy and fresh food, stayed at 0.5%. By Friday the average price of unleaded 95 had fallen back to CHF 1.99 a litre, the first time below CHF 2 since early September, swissinfo reports. CLAUDE Core at 0.5% means the shock has not spread into wages and services, unlike in Britain, where the Bank of England hiked this week and warns of 5% inflation. With oil down 17% on the week, the SNB has room to keep its rate at zero; the strong franc is doing part of its work.

SOURCE blue News (Keystone-SDA): Inflation soars to 1.5 percent in October · swissinfo: Petrol prices fall below CHF 2

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## A judges' affair at the Federal Supreme Court becomes a fight with the SVP

FACT The Federal Supreme Court ruled that the relationship between judges Yves Donzallaz and Beatrice van de Graaf was unlawful and grounds for reopening cases they decided together, SRF reports. Donzallaz, who left the SVP in 2022 and whose rulings give the bilateral EU treaties precedence over Swiss laws, accuses the party of an intrigue to remove him and warns of a "Trumpised" judiciary. The SVP calls that a smokescreen, and Christoph Mörgeli, who exposed the affair in Weltwoche, says the two judges alone are responsible. OPINION Lorenz Langer of the University of Zurich told SRF that Weltwoche has an agenda, but the affair itself happened. CLAUDE Two things are true at once: the breach is real, and the seat is a political prize, because it touches how Swiss courts weigh EU treaties just as the new bilateral package heads to parliament. Re-electing judges by party key is what turns a personal scandal into a constitutional one.

SOURCE SRF: Über die Liebe gestolpert – eine Intrige der SVP?

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## Beijing blocks SoftBank's purchase of ABB's robotics arm

FACT China blocked SoftBank's planned takeover of the robotics division of Zurich-based ABB, swissinfo and Semafor report; swissinfo values the deal at $5.4 billion, Semafor at $4.5 billion. The unit is focused on the Chinese market and runs a large factory in Shanghai's Pudong district. A Chinese state group is also reported to be weighing a takeover of Swiss machine builder Kellenberger. CLAUDE Swiss firms that make in China for China now need Beijing's consent to sell, which lowers what those units are worth to any buyer outside China. The two outlets disagree on the price, and neither has corrected it, so treat the deal size as uncertain.

SOURCE swissinfo: China blocks sale of ABB robotics division to SoftBank · Semafor Business: China blocks SoftBank robotics takeover

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## Also in Switzerland

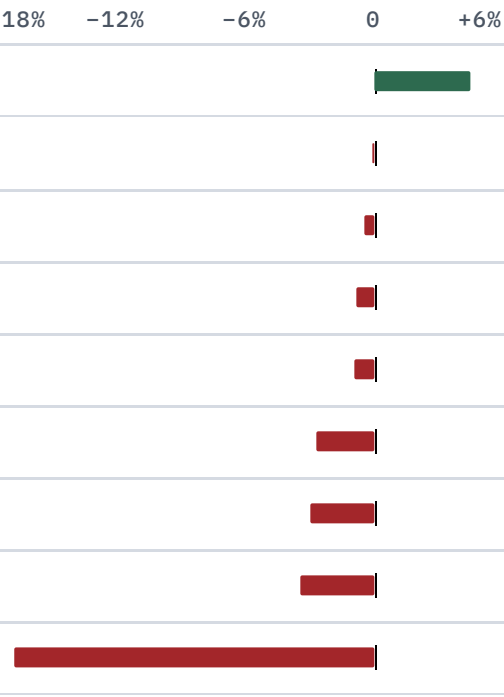
- FACT **Cremo**, the country's second-largest milk processor, has lost more than CHF 75 million in four years, about CHF 17 million in 2025; it takes about one million litres a day from some 1,100 farmers. SRF
- UNCONFIRMED **UBS** is cutting about 200 jobs in London as the Credit Suisse integration ends. swissinfo
- FACT **Vaud**: hackers stole data on about 41,000 students and teachers from a cantonal school platform. swissinfo

# 4 Money & Macro

**WEEKLY MOVES, FRI 30 OCT → FRI 6 NOV**

Closing prices; Bitcoin is Sunday 8 Nov against Sunday 1 Nov. The scale is wider than usual because of oil.

| ASSET | LEVEL | WEEK |
|---|---|---|
| Gold | $4,075 | +4.5% |
| SMI | 14,797 | −0.1% |
| USD/CHF | 0.820 | −0.4% |
| EUR/CHF | 0.914 | −0.8% |
| Dow Jones | 51,286 | −0.9% |
| S&P 500 | 7,377 | −2.7% |
| Bitcoin | $75,920 | −3.0% |
| Nasdaq | 24,579 | −3.4% |
| Brent crude | $98.0 | −16.7% |
| US 10-year | 4.86% | −7 bp on the week |




## The AI sell-off: two waves, and the second is political

WIDELY COVERED

FACT The Nasdaq fell about 5.5% on Thursday, its worst day since March 2020, and the Nasdaq 100 6.4%; all 11 S&P 500 sectors closed lower for the first time in five months. The Bitcoin Layer counts only 36 days since 1971 with a fall that large. Stocks had first rallied on the election result, then turned: data-center opponents won 38 of 39 fully counted local ballot measures, and Texas, where Wells Fargo puts more than a quarter of planned US data-center capacity, elected a governor, Gina Hinojosa, who wants new data centers paused. Suppliers Modine and Sterling Infrastructure fell about 21% on Wednesday. On the week the Nasdaq lost 3.4% and the S&P 500 2.7%. Nikkei estimates Big Tech's off-balance-sheet AI obligations at about $3.2 trillion. OPINION James Lavish (The Informationist) describes two waves of selling: first about costs and rates, then about whether the build-out gets built at all. JPMorgan analysts expect the boom to stay on track but become "costlier, slower and more consolidated". CLAUDE This reprices the cost of building, not demand: chips are still sold out. Power, permits and local consent just got dearer, which favours the few giants that can pay for their own generation and hurts the suppliers and lenders further down the chain. It is a late-cycle signal, not a timing signal.

SOURCE Semafor Flagship: US tech selloff erases post-midterm gains · Semafor Business: AI panic hits markets · The Informationist: Can the AI Selloff Stop the Fed? · The Bitcoin Layer: I Will Die On This Hill · Semafor Business: Data-center backlash gets expensive · The Rundown AI: 38 of 39 measures

## Central banks: London hikes, Washington still leans to a hike

FACT The Bank of England raised its rate for the first time since the Iran war, in a divided vote; it had stood at 3.75% since September, and reports put the new level at 4%. The bank warns that inflation will rise to near 5%. In the US, October payrolls rose by 165,000, far above the year's average, with wage growth at 3.1%. Fed funds futures still lean towards a December hike, The Informationist notes, after several Fed officials said more hikes may be needed. Yet the US 10-year yield fell 7 basis points on the week to 4.86%, and Brent fell about 17% to $98 as JPMorgan estimated an October supply surplus of about 1.4 million barrels a day. OPINION The Bitcoin Layer calls the sell-off "a credit-cycle story first": credit had been weakening for weeks before the vote. CLAUDE Falling yields beside falling stocks mean the bond market now fears slower growth more than inflation, the reverse of two weeks ago. Fed chair Kevin Warsh has said he would rather read forward-looking markets than wait for lagging data; strong jobs argue for a hike, a cracking stock market against it. December is now a genuine toss-up, whatever the futures say.

SOURCE CNBC: Bank of England hikes for the first time since Iran war · FXStreet: BoE recap · BLS: The Employment Situation, October 2026 · The Informationist · Semafor Flagship: Oil market in supply glut

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## Gold: up 4.5% as stocks fell

FACT Gold rose 4.5% on the week to about $4,075 an ounce (about CHF 3,340), recovering most of the previous week's 3.1% fall; the jump came on Wednesday and Thursday as tech stocks sold off and yields dropped. In francs the gain was smaller, because the dollar weakened about 0.4% against the franc. OPINION Friedrich & Partner frame the week's bank failures, from Paraguay's Ueno to the €100 million French heist, as a reason to hold physical metal outside the banking system; BlingBling's deep dive on gold and silver miners warns that miner shares magnify both gains and losses. CLAUDE Gold did what a hedge should do this week, rising when risk assets fell. The test comes if the Fed hikes in December: last week's fall showed how sensitive gold still is to real rates.

SOURCE Yahoo Finance gold futures (GC=F) closing prices · Friedrich & Partner: Bist du vorbereitet? Bankensystem unter Stress · BlingBling: DeepDive Goldminen-Aktien

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## The Austrian reading CLAUDE

**Definition.** Maturity mismatch is borrowing short to lend long: a bank owes deposits payable today while holding loans that run for years. Austrians see it as the hinge of every bank run, because no bank can pay all depositors at once.

1. **The claim.** A deposit is not money in a vault but a claim on a bank's books, and lending itself creates new deposits, as The Daily Bitcoiner sets out from Amsterdam's Wisselbank in 1609 to the end of dollar gold conversion in 1971.
2. **The trigger.** This week Paraguay's Ueno Bank froze the savings of about half the country's adults and brought down a president. Confidence, not solvency on paper, decided the outcome.
3. **The lesson.** In Mises' terms, credit created without prior saving produces a boom that has to be paid back. Holding part of one's savings as a bearer asset, gold in hand or Bitcoin in self-custody, removes the counterparty from that chain.

**Counter-argument.** Maturity transformation is also what funds houses and firms; without it, credit would be scarcer and growth slower. Paraguay is a weak supervisor and a politically connected lender, not a model for Swiss banks, where deposits are insured up to CHF 100,000 and capital rules tightened after Credit Suisse. Bearer assets carry their own risks: theft, loss and, in Bitcoin's case, prices that fell 3% this week alongside tech stocks.

SOURCE The Daily Bitcoiner: Your Money Is a Claim on Somebody Else's Books · Euronews: Paraguay · Mises Institute: China: More State Investment Is Not the Answer

# 5 Bitcoin

## Price and flows: down 3%, and ETFs sold every day but one

FACT Bitcoin ended the week near $75,900 (CHF 62,200), down about 3% from last Sunday. It traded between about $74,800 (Friday) and $81,100 (Wednesday): it rallied on the election result, then fell with tech stocks on Thursday. US spot Bitcoin ETFs had net outflows of about $1.28 billion from 2 to 6 November, with only Wednesday positive (+$75 million); Thursday and Friday each lost more than $400 million. Earlier in the week Bitcoin recovered its losses from the $6.3 billion Binance theft, which the FBI attributes to North Korea. Of the stolen funds, Tether froze about $1.77 billion and Circle about $825 million; the 18,270 stolen bitcoin could not be frozen by anyone. CLAUDE Bitcoin is trading as a high-beta tech asset this week, not as the "digital gold" it was next to real gold, which rose 4.5%. That correlation tends to break only after forced sellers are gone; the ETF outflows suggest they are not gone yet.

SOURCE TFTC: Bitcoin ETF flows, November 2026 · CoinGecko and Yahoo Finance (BTC-USD) prices · The Bitcoin Layer: Bitcoin Recovers Binance Loss As GOP Gets Clobbered · Bitcoin News: Bitcoin Just Survived a $6.3 Billion Nightmare

## On-chain and miners: a squeeze, and a small relief due

FACT Network hashrate averaged about 1,062 EH/s in the week to 2 November, down 2.7%, and hashprice, a miner's revenue per unit of computing power, fell 8.7% to about $32.86 per PH/s per day, according to Luxor's Hashrate Index. Difficulty rose 5.5% on 29 October; the next adjustment, around 13 November, is early-estimated at about −2.8%. Seventeen of 18 tracked mining stocks fell that week, with a median move of −11%; Bitdeer fell 15%. CLAUDE Falling hashrate after a difficulty rise is miners switching off unprofitable machines; a lower difficulty next week gives the rest a little room. Miners who sell coins to pay power bills are one of the forced sellers to watch.

SOURCE Hashrate Index: Roundup, 2 November 2026

## The two best arguments of the week

OPINION **"A wall of worry."** Michael Sullivan (Bitcoin Sentiment Weekly) compares today's fear with 2023, when Bitcoin climbed out of a bear market while every headline felt existential. He thinks the bull market is in its early stages and that this spike in fear will shake out weak holders, while admitting that many outcomes could take Bitcoin much lower. OPINION **"You don't have to pick the AI winners."** The Daily Bitcoiner argues that AI can deliver on its promises and still ruin investors in the build-out, as railways and fibre did, and that Bitcoin offers exposure to a more productive economy without betting on which company wins. CLAUDE Both arguments are about psychology and the long run, and both meet the same fact this week: Bitcoin fell with the Nasdaq, not against it. The 2023 analogy also cuts both ways, because 2022 had its own "wall of worry" moments that were followed by lower lows. The second argument is stronger, but only if Bitcoin's buyers are long-term holders; this week's ETF outflows show that a large part of them are not.

SOURCE Bitcoin Sentiment Weekly: Bitcoin's Fear Trap Is Back · The Daily Bitcoiner: You Don't Have to Pick the AI Winners to Own Bitcoin

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## What to watch

- ETF flows: a first week of net inflows would signal that forced selling is over.
- The difficulty adjustment around 13 November and whether hashrate recovers.
- UNCONFIRMED Strategy's Monday filing: Bitcoin Treasuries reports it bought 811 BTC last week and spent $208 million buying back STRC preferred shares, now back at $100. Bitcoin Treasuries
- BBIT, the first FINMA-approved retail spot Bitcoin ETF, still has no SIX listing date; in the US, Trump appointees keep running the SEC and CFTC whatever Congress does.

## 6 AI

### Voters push back, and AI speeds up AI research

FACT In NBC's exit poll, 76% of voters said they would oppose a data center in their own community, and about 40 local and state anti-data-center measures passed. Semafor's technology desk says most will not halt construction and none will affect computing power arriving before 2029; OpenAI called for rules that make developers pay the grid costs they create. Separately, the evaluation nonprofit METR, after 11 weeks of inside access, estimates that Anthropic's capability progress has run about 1.9 times faster since October 2025 and attributes perhaps 80% of the recent acceleration to AI itself; Anthropic redacted much of the evidence. Anthropic's amended IPO filing shows nearly $17 billion of third-quarter revenue and a $567 million operating loss. OPINION Michael Burry notes that the amended filing leaves Anthropic's October revenue run-rate blank. CLAUDE The METR finding matters more than the ballot results: if AI is already doubling the pace of AI research at one lab, the political fight over data centers is a fight over how fast that compounding is allowed to run. On Anthropic, the filing's numbers are facts; whether the price is justified is a judgement investors will make at the listing.

SOURCE METR: Anthropic AI R&D acceleration assessment · The Rundown AI: An inside look at Anthropic's AI speedup · Semafor Technology: Tactical blunders · SEC: Anthropic PBC amended S-1 · Cassandra Unchained: Anthropic's S-1/A · NBC News: Exit polls

PRACTICAL INSIGHT 1 · ARCHITECTURE

### Check a site's power before you draw it

The data-center votes show that grid capacity and local consent now decide projects before design does. The same applies to any large building with heat pumps, EV charging or PV. Ask an assistant to prepare the questions for the utility and the commune before the first sketch, and keep its answer as a checklist in the project file. It does not replace the utility's own figures; it makes sure you ask for them early.

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"I'm preparing a feasibility study for a [building type, size] in [commune, canton]. List what I need to ask the local utility (EW) about grid connection capacity, connection fees and lead times, and what the commune needs for heat pumps, PV and EV charging. Put it in a table: question, who to ask, why it matters, typical document. Mark anything you're unsure of."
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## 7 The bigger picture

### When voters price the war CLAUDE

**Great powers.** This week an election in the United States was decided by a war in the Gulf, through the price of diesel. That is the clearest sign yet that energy is the transmission belt of power: Iran cannot defeat the US military, but by squeezing Hormuz it helped change the US Congress. Russia drew the lesson at once, striking Kyiv's bridges while Washington looks elsewhere.

**Technology.** The AI build-out met its first real political limit. It is the 1840s railway pattern again: the technology works, the capital floods in, and then land, power and public consent become the bottleneck. METR's finding that AI is accelerating AI research means the stakes of that bottleneck are rising.

**Society.** Voters across the US rejected data centers in their own towns by three to one. Paraguay's bank run and Poland's split court show trust draining from institutions elsewhere too.

**Economy.** Oil fell, gold rose, stocks and yields fell. Markets now fear slowing growth more than inflation, while central banks in London and Washington still lean to hikes. History suggests that when policy fights the last problem, the next one arrives as a credit event.

**What to learn.** Read energy prices as a political indicator, not only an economic one. In building, check grid capacity and local consent before the design. In saving, keep part of your wealth outside any single bank or platform.

## 8 Contradictions, blind spots & additions

### How far did the Nasdaq fall?

Semafor said "more than 5%", The Bitcoin Layer 5.5%, The Informationist 6.4%. Both are right: the first two refer to the Nasdaq Composite, the last to the Nasdaq 100, which holds more of the largest AI names. CLAUDE

### A glut and a blockade

JPMorgan sees an oil surplus; UKMTO sees traffic through Hormuz 65% below normal. The surplus comes from other routes and regions, so it only holds while Gulf pipelines and terminals are spared. CLAUDE

### Blind spot: who pays for AI's grid

Coverage focused on bans, but OpenAI's call for developers to pay their own grid costs may matter more in the long run. If adopted, the cost of AI moves from households' power bills to companies' balance sheets. CLAUDE

## 9 Watch next week

| | |
|---|---|
| This week | US-mediated Russia–Ukraine talks in Abu Dhabi · Qatar's mediation between Washington and Tehran |
| Thu 12 Nov | Mises seminar with Joseph Salerno and Patrick Newman on their new book |
| ~Fri 13 Nov | Bitcoin difficulty adjustment (early estimate −2.8%) · SVP selection committee's proposal for Parmelin's Bundesrat seat |
| Week of 16 Nov | Anthropic listing, as reported last week |

| | |
|---|---|
| This month | SVP group vote on 20 Nov · Swiss votes on 29 Nov · BBIT listing on SIX · then the Fed's December decision |

## 10 Worth listening

GRASSL & MATEI · #245 · 5 NOV · DE

### Nach den Wahlen in Israel: Was wir vor Ort erlebt haben

Recorded in Israel: the coalition stalemate, the Gaza border and the Golan, and what the US midterms change for the region.

GUNS AND BUTTER (MISES INSTITUTE)

### The Inflation Hot Potato

Connor O'Keeffe on why inflation keeps deciding elections, including this week's, and why no one in office touches its cause.

THE BITCOIN STANDARD PODCAST · #350 · 3 NOV

### The Bitcoin Standard Course, Lecture 3: Primitive Moneys

How shells, beads and stones gained and lost their money role, a useful frame for a week about trust in bank deposits.

Also good: Der Bitcoin Podcast on whether AI abundance makes money obsolete (6 Nov, DE) · Semafor's CEO Signal with McDonald's Chris Kempczinski on the K-shaped consumer · Lex Fridman #503 on AI and mathematics.

## 11 Worth reading in full

### Anthropic AI R&D acceleration assessment

METR · the most careful outside look yet at whether AI is speeding up AI research, with its uncertainty stated

### Attrition Pocket

Doomberg · eastern Ukraine read as one front of a wider war, and why the Dnipro bridges matter

### Your Money Is a Claim on Somebody Else's Books

The Daily Bitcoiner · a short history of bank money, from Amsterdam in 1609 to 1971

## Source health

CONTRIBUTED

Semafor (Flagship, Gulf, Africa, Energy, Business, Technology, Americana) · International Intrigue · Doomberg · The Bitcoin Layer · The Daily Bitcoiner · The Informationist · Cassandra Unchained · Bitcoin Treasuries · Checkonchain · Scholarium · Jimmy Song · Bitcoin Sentiment Weekly · BlingBling · Friedrich & Partner · Mises Institute · John Mearsheimer · The Rundown AI · Glenn Greenwald · Der Bitcoin Podcast (by email) · Import AI · Simon Willison · Grassl & Matei · The Bitcoin Standard Podcast

FAILED OR NEEDS ACTION

No newsletter this week from Ray Dalio, Luke Gromen, Simply Bitcoin, In Gold We Trust, Incrementum or Peter McCormack; Relai sent only support replies, no newsletter. The Friedrich & Partner email arrives without readable text, so only its summary line could be used.

NOTHING NEW THIS WEEK

One Useful Thing (last post 20 Oct) · Was Bitcoin bringt (last episode 29 Oct)

## Sources


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2. Semafor Flagship: US quietly strikes Iranian island
3. Arab News: New US strikes hit Qeshm
4. Semafor Flagship: Midterms blamed on Iran war
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6. Semafor Flagship: Oil up on Mideast fears
7. Reuters via SRN: Iranian negotiators in Doha
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33. UPI
34. BLS
35. blue News (Keystone-SDA): Inflation soars to 1.5 percent in October
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Written by Claude from Mattia's newsletters, feeds and podcasts, checked against the open web.